

## Remembering Pat: Going into Labor on a Recruiting Visit

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So, in 1991, I was a high school senior, and I was the National High School Player of the Year, heavily recruited by all the schools in the country. Pat Summit and the University of Tennessee was on their way to a home visit in Allentown, Pennsylvania, which is where I went to high school, where I lived.

I was coming home a little bit late. Once I got home, I just noticed that Pat was just a little bit hurried, kind of in an odd, sort of in a rushed way. We sat down and Pat was nice, but she was preoccupied and a little bit distracted. Everything seemed rushed. Pat kept getting up, going to the bathroom, coming back, getting up, going to the bathroom, coming back.

Finally, on Pat's like fourth or fifth trip to the bathroom, she came back and said, "Michelle, I'm afraid I'm going to have to cut this visit short."

She said, "My water broke getting off the plane. The baby is on its way."

And I just looked at her, and I said, "Like...now?"

And she was like, "Uh, yeah, so we have to go."

My dad knew about this. He said "OK, let's get you to the hospital." It was about three minutes away. She could go there, have a baby. Tyler would have been born in Allentown, Pennsylvania.

But she said, no. In true Pat Summit fashion, she said, "I want to go home, I want to have this baby in Knoxville."

My brother and I hopped in the car, we got there, we got to the plane, all we could do was get them out of their car and try to get Pat and Mickie on the right planes.

Well, they went through the gates, but the pilots wanted to make an emergency landing in Charlottesville, Virginia, where the University of Virginia is.

Pat would not let them land the plane because Tennessee had just lost to Virginia when Knoxville was hosting the Final Four.

So, Tennessee didn't get to the final four because they lost to Virginia. Pat said, "I'm not having this baby in Virginia. We're going to keep flying."

So, they're in the air, in the midst of, I think Mickie trying to take a whiskey shot because she had to calm her nerves. Pat was probably the calmer one to be really honest. But they flew the plane into Knoxville to an ambulance who took her into the airport, and they had a baby, Tyler. So that's how Tyler was born.